

Week 3 Day 1

Dataset coverage: 1983–2025 (43 seasons). Supplied files: player profiles, round-by-round player statistics, seasonal player statistics, and team home/away match records. Team-match table: 15,808 rows (7,904 home matches); round-by-round table: 274,089 player-game rows.

1. Target contract

Target	Definition	Level / use	Rule
match_result_home	HOME_WIN / AWAY_WIN / DRAW	Match	Home-row result: W / L / D
home_win_binary	1 if home team wins, else 0	Match	result == W
margin_home	Signed home scoring margin	Match regression	Home score – away score
top_disposal_getter	1 for player(s) tied for match-high disposals	Player-game	disposals == match maximum; missing if unavailable
top_goal_kicker	1 for player(s) with highest positive recorded goals	Player-game	goals == positive match maximum; missing when goals are unrecorded

2. Prediction-feature contract — v1.0

Feature	Meaning / window	Source
home/away_prior_win_rate_5	Win rate over previous 5 completed games; current game excluded	team result
home/away_prior_score_avg_5	Average score over previous 5 completed games	team_score
home/away_prior_margin_avg_5	Average margin over previous 5 completed games	margin
home/away_days_rest	Days since previous recorded match	match_date
home/away_prior_win_streak	Consecutive wins immediately before current match	result
home/away_prior_ladder_points / pct / rank	Season-to-date team strength before current match	prior results/scores
home/away_prior_h2h_team_wins / games	Prior wins and meetings in the team matchup	earlier meetings
form_diff_5	Home prior-5 win rate minus away prior-5 win rate	derived
score_avg_diff_5 / margin_avg_diff_5	Home minus away prior scoring / margin averages	derived
rest_diff	Home rest days minus away rest days	derived
ladder_points_diff / ladder_rank_diff	Home-minus-away points; away rank minus home rank	derived

player form features	Mean/max prior-5 player disposals, goals and fantasy points for each side	round_stats
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3. Data quality, leakage & split

Data quality: exact duplicate rows are removed before player-game target/rolling calculations. The player-info table contains fewer IDs than round stats and is optional enrichment. Position and weather analyses are unavailable because those fields are absent. Seasonal totals are descriptive only and are not used as pre-match features.	Leakage control: rolling team/player features use shift(1); season-to-date ladder values exclude the current match. Current-match result/score/goals/disposals/fantasy points are not predictors. Player-form aggregation uses current player identities and prior performance; a production pre-selection model should separately model availability. Split: train before 2025, hold out 2025. Near-perfect future-season accuracy should trigger a leakage audit.
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